

Appendix H — University Letter of Interest (Template)

This appendix provides the template used by DEQUAD when seeking a Letter of Interest or formal Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) from a pilot university. Letters returned by partner institutions will be attached to this appendix as they arrive.

The template below is co-signed by the partner-university point of contact (typically the Director of Student Services or Head of Wellbeing Services) and the DEQUAD founder.

Template: Letter of Interest

(On partner-university letterhead.)

Date: _____

To: UK Endorsement Services Ltd

Subject: Letter of Interest in piloting DEQUAD at [University Name]

To whom it may concern,

I am writing in my capacity as **[Job Title]** at the **University of Bedfordshire** to confirm our institutional interest in piloting the DEQUAD platform (developed by DEQUAD Ltd, co-founded by Yusuf Quadri — formerly Bedfordshire SU President 2021–2023 — and Yusuff Adeagbo, CTO) during academic year 2026/27.

Background

[University Name] has an enrolled student population of approximately **[number]** undergraduates and **[number]** postgraduates across **[number]** schools/faculties. Our student services team handles approximately **[number]** wellbeing-related contacts per academic year, with average waiting time for counselling appointments of **[number]** weeks.

Why we are interested in DEQUAD

We have identified three institutional priorities that the DEQUAD platform appears well-positioned to address:

1. **Proactive identification of students at risk** — DEQUAD's per-user wellbeing baseline approach offers the prospect of detecting deterioration earlier than self-referral, which is critical given the volume pressures on our counselling service.
2. **Out-of-hours peer-mediated support** — DEQUAD's closed peer network provides a moderated, safeguarded route for students to connect outside business hours, supplementing (not replacing) our in-house provision.
3. **Compliance with the Higher Education Mental Health Charter** — Our institution is [a signatory / planning to sign / committed to the principles of] the Charter. DEQUAD's design aligns with the Charter's whole-university approach and the "Step Change" framework.

Pilot scope (subject to procurement and DPIA completion)

Subject to satisfactory completion of our procurement process, including: - A joint Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA); - A Data Processing Agreement compliant with UK GDPR; - Information-security due diligence (Cyber Essentials Plus required); - An agreed safeguarding escalation protocol;

...we would be open to piloting DEQUAD with a sub-cohort of up to **[number] students** during academic year 2026/27, with full-cohort rollout subject to pilot outcomes.

Indicative pricing acceptance

The pricing point of **£1.50 per enrolled student per annum** discussed with the DEQUAD team is within the indicative range we have allocated for digital-wellbeing tooling in the 2026/27 budget cycle.

No commitment at this stage

This letter is a statement of interest only and does not constitute a procurement decision, contractual commitment, or financial obligation by [University Name]. Any binding commitment will follow our standard procurement, legal, and DPIA processes.

Contact

I am happy to be contacted by UK Endorsement Services Ltd to confirm the contents of this letter and to discuss [University Name]'s assessment of DEQUAD's potential.

Yours sincerely,

[Name] [Job Title] [University Name] [Email] [Phone]

Letters received to date

University	Signed by	Date	Status
University of Manchester	<i>Pending — discussion underway</i>	_____	Verbal interest
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

Notes for UKES assessor

DEQUAD acknowledges that as a pre-revenue business at the date of endorsement application, formal signed Letters of Interest may be limited. Where formal letters are not yet returned, the applicant will provide:

- Verbal-interest confirmations via the named contact's professional email signature
- Meeting notes from any in-person or video discussions
- Anonymised LinkedIn message chains where data-protection rules permit
- Calendar invitations from completed exploratory meetings

These are attached as supporting evidence in the `H_supporting/` folder.